

with this, the number of Primecoins awarded per block is also variable, in a positive correlation with the difficulty of the block.

Primecoin is the 12th largest cryptocurrency in the world with a market capitalisation of USD \$13,122,112 and 4,059,356 units as of January 2014.

### **Namecoin**

Namecoin is hybrid cryptocurrency that functions more than just a currency. Its created with the ability to be an alternative and decentralised DNS that seeks to protect domain names from censorship and take them out of the control of ICANN. It does this by creating a new top level domain outside ICANN.

Namecoin is the sixth largest cryptocurrency in the world (market cap = USD\$ 45,209,707) and uses a slightly modified version of the Bitcoin protocol. It is also restricted to 21 million units with 123,616 .bit domains being registered. Instead of awarding traditional “coins”, Namecoin awards .bit domains which are used as currency.

### **Dogecoin**

Dogecoin is the 13th largest cryptocurrency in the world as has a market cap of USD\$ 12,154,567. Its upper limit of production is at 100 billion units of which 28% have been mined. It is also the most recent addition to cryptocurrencies, having launched on 6 December 2013. It has seen remarkable growth since then, both in terms of interest from miners as



The only virtual currency to be based on an internet meme. Enough said.